

Creative Zen Portable Media Player

The Zen Portable Media Player from Creative is one of the early devices running on Microsoft's Portable Media Center software. Straight out of the box, the player is simply stunning, albeit a bit bulky, with a shiny black coating and a nice big 3.8-inch LCD screen. It fits into your hand and lets you play music, movies and photographs with ease.



In terms of the specs, it is powered by an Intel Scale 400MHz processor, 64 MB RAM and a 20 GB hard disk drive. The Zen's interface is extremely responsive. And all this despite the glitzy fade-in and smooth sliding effects within the Windows OS.

The controls are fairly simple and gameboy-ish.

Despite all these amazing features, the player does not identify as a removable drive, and drivers are needed to transfer music. It works on Windows Media Digital Rights Management 10, which prevents a movie file from loading into the player if not authorised by a Web server, which it connects to every time you sync it.

It plays only the WMV format, but does it well. If you have movies in other formats, WMP10 will first convert them and then upload them—a colossal waste of your time. The device plays music (MP3 and WMV formats), displays photographs and plays videos with élan. The interface is slick and extremely easy to navigate and makes scrolling through huge lists easy. If you can live with a slightly bulky (but well built) device, we would absolutely recommend this device.

Company **Creative Technology Ltd.**

Price **Rs 28,299**

Phone **0 - 9820357718**

Web site **www.creative.com**

Rating



Dell Latitude D410

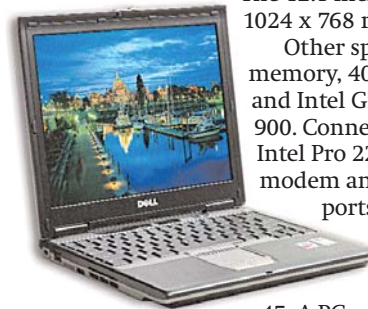
For Professional Laps

The Latitude D410 measures 1.25 x 11.0 x 9.4 inches and weighs just over 1.7 kg.

Powered by an Intel Pentium M Processor 760 (2.00GHz, 2MB L2 Cache) installed on an Intel 915GM chipset, the notebook offers the latest mobile offerings from Intel—including PCI-Express, DDR2 support and 533 MHz FSB.

The 12.1-inch screen supports 1024 x 768 resolution.

Other specs include 512 MB system memory, 40 GB 5400 RPM hard drive, and Intel Graphics Media Accelerator 900. Connectivity options include Intel Pro 2200 802.11b/g Wi-Fi, 56K modem and Gigabit LAN. Available ports include Docking connector, 3 USB, VGA, headphone/speaker out, infrared port, RJ-11, and RJ-45. A PC card slot is provided, though



FireWire and media card reader are not available.

Because of its reinforced magnesium alloy frame, the D410 is extremely sturdy, and comes with Dell's StrikeZone shock absorber system to protect the hard drive.

Both touchpad and pointing stick options are present. The notebook logged a whopping 23.9 in the Business Winstone Test and 3413 in PCMark04, making it one of the best performing notebooks we have ever tested. The included six-cell battery lasted a decent 2 hrs 39 minutes.

The D410 bundles an external combo-drive, Windows XP Professional with SP2, a nine-cell extended battery, leather carry bag and a 3-year on-site warranty.

Overall, the Latitude D410 will not disappoint frequent travellers who want great performance.

Company **Dell Computer India**

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Rating



iRiver N10 256MB MP3 player

Anti-piracy MP3 Player

The iRiver N10 is a sleek MP3 player with a memory capacity of 256 MB. It comes with a standard USB cable and earphones. The style is abstract and will appeal to people who want to flaunt their MP3 players.

The display is OLED which is very functional and actually helps in conserving battery life. The iRiver N10 can play Windows Media Audio and MP3 files.

Coming to performance, the player has very good sound quality. Its software lets you tweak just about anything you want, however, the controls are rather cumbersome to use. You can use the preset equalisers for listening to music or customise them as you wish.

Battery life is pretty good; with the player running non-stop for approximately 10.5 hours.

The player is plug-and-play and is recognised as a USB device when connected to a computer. You will, however, need to install the proprietary iRiver software before using the player. Using this bundled software, you can also store data in the player.

Another feature (or mis-feature) is that once you copy a song on to the player, you cannot copy it back to the

computer. According to iRiver, it is a step to prevent illegal transfer of music from one system to another.

The sound recording quality is good and recorded files are in .REC format, which can be converted to MP3 using the iRiver Music Manager software.

The player is feature-packed and boasts good performance but the price of Rs 8,499 is a big letdown.



Company **Salora International Ltd**

Price **Rs 8,499**

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Rating

